

Pierce County Auditor & Title Recording Records Guide

Status: Approved

Category: Ownership

Pierce County Auditor & Title Chain Intelligence

The Pierce County Auditor's Recording Department records all instruments affecting real property, including Deeds, Deeds of Trust (Mortgages), Liens, and Death Certificates.

1. Deed Vesting Types in Pierce County

- **Statutory Warranty Deed:** Full warranty of title; standard conveyance in WA.
- **Transfer on Death Deed (TODD):** Executed under RCW 64.80. **CRITICAL QC RULE:** If a valid TODD was recorded prior to death, the property **passes outside of probate court jurisdiction**. Disqualify from probate delivery.
- **Personal Representative Deed:** The statutory instrument used by the executor to convey title to the buyer at closing.

2. Encumbrance & Mortgage Tracing

Trace original Deed of Trust recording date. Properties held 15+ years typically have substantial equity. Check specifically for **Home Equity Conversion Mortgages (HECM / Reverse Mortgages)**—if balance exceeds market value, file is disqualified in QC.